

THE BIG PICTURE

Borrowing Cost

Fear Index

Mid-Term Rates

Gold (Safety)

Cash Rate

WHERE THE SMART MONEY IS GOING

REAL0.12

ENERG0.46

UTILI0.52

TECHN0.59

FINAN1.17

CONS.1.22

COMM.1.31

HEALT1.44

INDUS1.99

CONS.2.10

MATER57.64

1

MU

BUY

\$973.50

+2.49%

8/10

The AI memory supercycle is running hot — MU is a core beneficiary of

2

NVDA

BUY

\$225.67

+0.16%

8/10

The picks-and-shovels play on a government-blessed AI buildout, with C

3

GOOGL

BUY

\$348.04

+0.49%

8/10

Alphabet's Gemini + Cloud + Waymo trifecta is compounding while antitr

Big options bets on SBUX (Other) — 27.4x normal volume, P/C 0.21, largest: CALL \$105 (2471.0x OI)

No unusual behind-the-scenes trading to flag

No Congress members buying or selling stocks this week

EARNINGS COMING UP

No major earnings this week

FED & ECONOMY TODAY

CPI

Date: 2026-08-14

HIGH

VIX at 14.5 — low. Options market complacent ahead of scheduled events.

PPI [HIGH]

SHORTS GETTING SQUEEZED?

No squeeze setups detected

ARE BIG INSTITUTIONS NERVOUS?

BUYING PROTECTION

Junk bonds: cautious · Safe bonds: in demand · borrowing getting pricier (stress)

WHERE MONEY IS ROTATING

Big money is piling into Real Estate in a way that's hard to ignore — a put/call ratio of 0.12 with volume running 5x normal means somebody is betting hard that rates are about to come down, which lines up with the growing pressure on the Fed from the White House and the softer economic data we've been seeing.

The rotation into Utilities and Energy alongside REITs tells me institutions are positioning for a "lower rates plus energy dominance" playbook, likely anticipating continued deregulation, LNG export expansion, and the permitting reform tucked into recent legislation.

On the flip side, the smart money is quietly running for the exits in Consumer Discretionary (4x volume, P/C over 2) and Industrials — this is the tariff trade in reverse, where traders are betting that tariff pass-through costs and stretched consumers finally crack retail earnings, while Industrials get hit by retaliatory measures and slowing capex.

The Healthcare bearishness is almost certainly about drug pricing executive orders and Medicare negotiation expansion that isn't getting front-page coverage but is very real in Washington.

What jumps out as contradictory: Tech shows bullish signals even as Communication Services (which houses Google and Meta) is being hedged aggressively

YOUR WATCHLIST — HOW WE FEEL ABOUT EACH

1.

SMCI

Super Micro Computer, Inc.

SMCI is the leading AI server integrator with direct exposure to

8.91/100
2.

LDOS

Leidos Holdings, Inc.

Leidos combines defense IT modernization, cyber, and health contr

8.91/100
3.

KTOS

Kratos Defense & Security Solu

Kratos is a pure-play on unmanned systems, tactical drones, and h

8.61/100

DEEP DIVES — FULL REPORTS START ON PAGE 3

Pages 3–4	MU	— Micron Technology, Inc.	Buy	Conviction 8/10
Pages 5–6	NVDA	— NVIDIA Corporation	Buy	Conviction 8/10
Pages 7–8	GOOGL	— Alphabet Inc.	Buy	Conviction 8/10
Pages 9–10	AAPL	— Apple Inc.	Buy	Conviction 7/10
Pages 11–12	AMZN	— Amazon.com, Inc.	Buy	Conviction 7/10
Pages 13–14	META	— Meta Platforms, Inc.	Buy	Conviction 7/10
Pages 15–16	MRVL	— Marvell Technology, Inc.	Buy	Conviction 7/10
Pages 17–18	PLTR	— Palantir Technologies Inc.	Hold	Conviction 6/10
Pages 19–20	SPCX	— Procure Space ETF	Hold	Conviction 6/10
Pages 21–22	HOOD	— Robinhood Markets, Inc.	Hold	Conviction 6/10
Pages 23–24	TSLA	— Tesla, Inc.	Hold	Conviction 5/10

Apple Inc.
AAPL NASDAQ

Buy **\$306.71 ▲ 0.48%** 12M Price Target **\$340.00** 52-Week Range **\$223.78 – \$344.57** Market Cap **\$4.48T**

AAPL: \$60B Texas Bet Signals Trump-Era Reshoring Play

WHAT HAPPENED

- The big story: Tim Cook opened Apple's Houston Advanced Manufacturing Center and committed \$60B to Texas — this is Cook's political closing act. Reshoring Mac mini production to the US is really about buying tariff protection and White House favor, not economics.
- Apple also officially launched ads in Maps — small in dollars today, but it signals Apple is squeezing more Services revenue (the high-margin, 70%+ gross margin business Wall Street pays a premium for).

WHY IT MATTERS

The \$60B Texas bet isn't really about manufacturing efficiency — it's a political insurance policy. With the Trump administration wielding tariffs as leverage, Apple is essentially prepaying for exemptions and goodwill, similar to how TSMC and Samsung played the CHIPS Act. This probably means Apple secures favorable treatment on China-sourced components (still ~80% of iPhone supply chain) even as competitors get hit — a huge margin moat. But watch the put flow: someone's spending \$55M+ on August puts at \$330-345, meaning smart money is hedging near-term downside even though the long-term story is strengthening. That tension (bullish narrative, bearish short-term positioning) is why I'd buy pullbacks, not chase strength here.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

The critical policy angle right now is Trump's semiconductor and consumer electronics tariff regime — Apple's Houston announcement is directly designed to earn exemptions. Watch for a formal tariff carve-out or executive order naming Apple as a "strategic domestic manufacturer" in coming weeks; that would be a major catalyst. Separately, the EU Digital Markets Act continues to squeeze App Store economics (~\$25B Services revenue at risk long-term), and the DOJ antitrust case on iPhone ecosystem restrictions is still winding through courts — both are slow bleeds rather than acute threats.

IS IT EXPENSIVE?

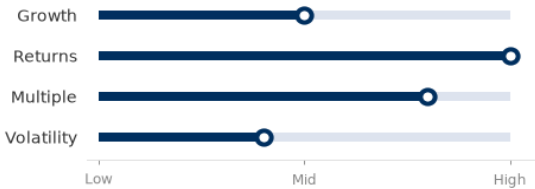
At \$306, Apple trades at roughly 42x forward earnings — meaning you're paying \$42 for every \$1 of profit next year, versus the S&P 500 at ~22x and Apple's own 10-year average around 22x. That's expensive, and only justifies itself if Services keeps growing 15%+ and iPhone unit sales stabilize. The \$4.48T market cap already prices in a lot of AI/Services optimism — you're not buying cheap, you're buying quality and the political moat.

WHAT COULD GO WRONG

Key Data

Price (USD)	\$306.71
12M Price Target	\$340.00
Upside / (Downside)	+10.9%
Market Cap	\$4.48T
FY2026E Revenue	\$425M
FY2027E Revenue	\$455M
FY2026E EPS	\$7.35
FY2027E EPS	\$8.10
Fwd P/E	41.7x

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P; 500



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$325.00	\$310.00	\$290.00
6 Months	\$355.00	\$325.00	\$275.00
1 Year	\$385.00	\$340.00	\$260.00
2 Years	\$450.00	\$380.00	\$250.00
5 Years	\$600.00	\$475.00	\$275.00
10 Years	\$900.00	\$650.00	\$300.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Energy (+7.2% this week) is ripping on Middle East tensions and summer demand — that's a macro signal that inflation fears are creeping back, which usually pressures megacap tech multiples.

COOLING OFF: Consumer Discretionary (-0.9% five-day) is weak, suggesting the consumer is tapping out — a yellow flag for iPhone demand into the fall launch.

ROTATION WATCH: Money is quietly rotating from growth into energy and defensives. Apple is holding up because it's increasingly viewed as a "safe" megacap rather than a growth name — which is fine, but caps upside.

RELATED PLAY: If Apple's reshoring narrative works, US industrial automation and semi-equipment names (think ROK, LRCX, AMAT) benefit directly — they're the picks-and-shovels for domestic manufacturing buildouts.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- MSFT (Microsoft): Winning the enterprise AI monetization race with Copilot — more concrete AI revenue than Apple.
- NVDA (Nvidia): Still the AI infrastructure king; every Apple/Houston-style buildout eventually buys Nvidia chips.

AAPL CONTEXT: Apple is lagging the AI-native megacaps (MSFT, NVDA, GOOGL) on the "who's winning AI" narrative but leading on political positioning and capital return. It's the "boring compounder" of the Mag 7 right now — that's actually where you want to be if we get a market wobble.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

7/10 Conviction Score

CONVICTION: 7/10 — high-quality core holding with a real policy tailwind, but not cheap and near-term options flow is cautious.

POSITION SIZE: 4-6% as a core position — this is a "sleep well at night" name, not a swing-for-the-fences trade.

ENTRY POINTS: I'd add on pullbacks to \$295-302, especially if we get a macro fear day driven by tariff headlines (paradoxically the best buying opportunities for AAPL right now).

TIME HORIZON: 12-24 months — the catalyst I'm waiting for is formal tariff exemption announcement and the iPhone 18 sell-through data in November.

WHEN TO BAIL: If iPhone unit sales drop more than 8% year-over-year, or if China revenue falls off a cliff (>15% decline), the thesis breaks and I'm out.

HEDGING: Buy cheap downside protection — a put option 10% below current price expiring in six months is like paying a small insurance premium against a China-related shock. Or simply don't oversize the position.

Palantir Technologies Inc.

PLTR NYSE

Hold	\$179.13 ▲ 0.07%	12M Price Target \$195.00	52-Week Range \$106.37 – \$207.52	Market Cap \$430.57B
------	------------------	------------------------------	--------------------------------------	-------------------------

PLTR: Sitting Near Highs as Burry Bets Against It

WHAT HAPPENED

- Stock bounced back to \$179 yesterday after a three-day slide, but today's volume is anemic (3.7M shares vs 40M+ typical) — that's a low-conviction move, likely just drift ahead of the weekend. The Chamath comment about PLTR winning the "model-agnostic AI" shift matters because it reinforces the bull thesis: PLTR doesn't care which AI model wins (OpenAI, Anthropic, etc.), they're the plumbing layer that plugs any model into enterprise data.
- Michael Burry (the "Big Short" guy) reportedly loaded up on PLTR bearish bets alongside NVDA and TSLA shorts — worth noting but not panic-worthy. Burry has been early/wrong on AI for two years running, but when a well-known bear stacks positions against you at these multiples, expect more volatility.

WHY IT MATTERS

Here's the real story: PLTR is trading at 72% of its 52-week range with a market cap north of \$430B — this is no longer a hidden gem, it's a consensus long that everyone owns. The insider selling (Shyam Sankar, the President, dumped shares Aug 6) combined with Burry's short positioning tells you smart money thinks the risk/reward is stretched here, even if the business is firing on all cylinders. That said, the options flow is mildly bullish (put/call at 1.05 is basically neutral) and institutions still own 64.5% — nobody's rushing for the exits. The takeaway: this is a "hold what you have, don't chase" setup. The next real catalyst is Q3 earnings and any news on the defense authorization bill in Congress.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

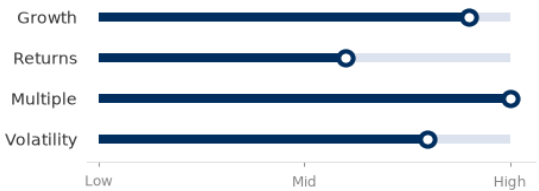
The FY2027 National Defense Authorization Act (NDAA) is the single biggest policy variable for PLTR right now — the House version includes expanded funding for AI-enabled command and control systems (JADC2, Maven), which is PLTR's bread and butter. If the Senate version keeps or expands those buckets, PLTR's government revenue line has visible runway into 2028. Separately, watch the ongoing federal AI procurement executive order — the administration has been pushing "American AI stack" preferences, and PLTR is arguably the biggest beneficiary since foreign competitors (like European or Chinese AI firms) get shut out of sensitive contracts.

IS IT EXPENSIVE?

Key Data

Price (USD)	\$179.13
12M Price Target	\$195.00
Upside / (Downside)	+8.9%
Market Cap	\$430.57B
FY2026E Revenue	\$4,850M
FY2027E Revenue	\$6,400M
FY2026E EPS	\$0.68
FY2027E EPS	\$0.92
Fwd P/E	263.4x

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P 500



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$200.00	\$182.00	\$160.00
6 Months	\$230.00	\$195.00	\$145.00
1 Year	\$260.00	\$210.00	\$130.00
2 Years	\$320.00	\$240.00	\$110.00
5 Years	\$500.00	\$320.00	\$90.00
10 Years	\$800.00	\$450.00	\$60.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Energy (+7.2% over 5 days) is on a tear — likely a mix of geopolitical premium and rotation out of overheated tech. Defense and aerospace remain strong on the NDAA tailwind (GE Aerospace mentioned in headlines is a tell).

COOLING OFF: Consumer Discretionary is down 0.9% over 5 days — consumer is getting pinched by sticky rates and tariff pass-through on imports.

ROTATION WATCH: Money is quietly rotating from mega-cap tech into energy and defense — that's actually a mixed signal for PLTR because it sits in both the "expensive AI" bucket (getting sold) and the "defense beneficiary" bucket (getting bought). Net-net PLTR is holding up, which tells you the defense narrative is winning.

RELATED PLAY: If you like the government-AI thesis but hate PLTR's valuation, look at defense primes like Lockheed (LMT) or L3Harris (LHX) — they're PLTR's biggest customers and often partners on the same contracts, at 15-20x earnings instead of 260x.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- GE (GE Aerospace): Defense and propulsion strength driving it — direct beneficiary of the same defense spending cycle helping PLTR.
- Energy sector broadly (XLE +7.2% in 5 days): geopolitical premium and supply discipline are pushing crude higher.

PLTR CONTEXT: PLTR is a leader within AI/software but is now trading like a defense-tech hybrid — it's holding its highs while other high-multiple software names are cooling. That relative strength is bullish short-term but also means when the correction comes, PLTR has more air underneath it than peers.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

6/10 Conviction Score

Position Size: 2-3% of portfolio

Entry Points: \$155-165 on pullbacks

Time Horizon: 12-24 months

Thesis Invalidation: Two consecutive quarters of decelerating commercial growth, or major DoD contract loss

Hedging: Buy longer-dated puts or pair with a short on another high-multiple AI name

Amazon.com, Inc.

AMZN NASDAQ

Buy	\$264.76 ▼ 0.14%	12M Price Target \$310.00	52-Week Range \$196.00 – \$287.20	Market Cap \$2.86T
-----	------------------	------------------------------	--------------------------------------	-----------------------

AMZN: Retail Weakness Bites, But AI Cloud Story Intact

WHAT HAPPENED

- Stock is down about 5% over the last 4 days — the July retail sales print came in weak (unexpectedly negative), which spooks anyone holding a name that literally has "retail" in its DNA. Volume today is a fraction of prior days, so this is drift, not panic — the real sellers already moved.
- The WSJ piece on Big Tech "inflating each other's earnings" (basically: AWS sells cloud to OpenAI, OpenAI's backers buy Nvidia chips, everyone books revenue from each other) is the kind of narrative that starts small and becomes a regulatory problem later. Worth filing away.

WHY IT MATTERS

Here's the tension: weak retail sales SHOULD hurt Amazon more than most, but the stock is only down 14 basis points today — meaning the market is basically saying "we own AMZN for AWS and ads now, retail is just ballast." That's a subtle but important shift in how this name trades. The Bezos \$346M sale on Aug 3 near the highs (\$286) looks like classic pre-scheduled 10b5-1 selling, but the timing at the top of the range is a tell — insiders aren't buying this level. Meanwhile options flow is loudly bullish (put/call 0.53, big unusual call buying) which tells me fast money is positioning for a bounce into the next AWS data point or a Fed-cut narrative if consumer data keeps weakening.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

Two things to watch: (1) The FTC antitrust case against Amazon is still grinding through the courts — a ruling or settlement framework could drop any time and would be the biggest single-day mover for this stock. (2) Tariff policy on Chinese imports directly hits Amazon's third-party sellers (over 60% of units sold), and the administration's ongoing trade posturing means margin pressure on the retail segment is a live risk. On the tailwind side, federal AI infrastructure spending and defense cloud contracts (JWCC — the Pentagon's \$9B multi-cloud deal AWS shares) keep flowing, which is why AWS growth stays sticky even when consumer names wobble.

IS IT EXPENSIVE?

At ~39x forward earnings, you're paying \$39 for every \$1 of next year's profit — not cheap, but roughly in line with where AMZN has traded during AWS growth acceleration phases. The key: if AWS is growing 18-20% and margins are expanding, that multiple is fair; if AWS slips to low-teens growth, this is expensive. Right now the setup justifies the price, but there's no margin of safety at these levels — which is why I'd rather add on pullbacks than chase.

WHAT COULD GO WRONG

Langston's | Equity Research Coverage

AI-Generated Pre-Market Brief | 2026-08-14 13:58 UTC

This report is prepared by Langston's using SEC EDGAR filings, market data (yfinance), and AI-generated analysis. It does not constitute investment advice. All figures are estimates. Past performance is not indicative of future results. Investors should conduct their own due diligence.

Key Data

Price (USD)	\$264.76
12M Price Target	\$310.00
Upside / (Downside)	+17.1%
Market Cap	\$2.86T
FY2026E Revenue	\$730M
FY2027E Revenue	\$810M
FY2026E EPS	\$6.85
FY2027E EPS	\$8.20
Fwd P/E	38.7x

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P 500



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$285.00	\$270.00	\$250.00
6 Months	\$315.00	\$285.00	\$240.00
1 Year	\$340.00	\$310.00	\$230.00
2 Years	\$400.00	\$355.00	\$220.00
5 Years	\$550.00	\$450.00	\$250.00
10 Years	\$850.00	\$650.00	\$300.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Energy (+7.2% over 5 days) is running on geopolitical/supply tightness — that's usually a warning sign for consumer discretionary because gasoline eats disposable income. Utilities and Comm Services quietly bid, suggesting some defensive rotation.

COOLING OFF: Consumer Discretionary (-0.9% over 5 days) — this is exactly the group AMZN sits in, and weak retail sales just confirmed why. Money is fading the consumer story.

ROTATION WATCH: Cash is moving from consumer-facing names into energy and defensives, which means AMZN's discretionary label is a headwind — but its AWS/AI classification is a tailwind. This stock is caught between two identities right now, which explains the drift.

RELATED PLAY: If you like the AWS thesis but want less retail exposure, the data center REITs (EQIX, DLR) and power infrastructure names (VRT, GEV) capture the same AI capex wave without the consumer risk.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- **GOOGL (Alphabet):** Two separate research notes this morning highlighting Alphabet's cloud/AI leadership — Citizens is literally paying a higher multiple for GOOG than AMZN, which tells you where the narrative momentum sits right now.
- **META (Meta Platforms):** Ad businesses are holding up better than pure e-commerce because they're less exposed to tariff-squeezed sellers.

AMZN CONTEXT: AMZN is lagging its mega-cap tech peers this week because it's the only one with real consumer exposure — that's actually a setup, not a warning. When retail fears subside or the Fed pivots, AMZN tends to snap back harder than GOOG or META because it's been the laggard.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

7/10 Conviction Score

CONVICTION: 7/10 — I like the business but I don't love the entry point; I'd be more excited \$10 lower.

POSITION SIZE: 4-6% — this is a core holding, not a trade. Big enough to matter, small enough that an FTC surprise doesn't ruin your year.

ENTRY POINTS: Add in the \$255-262 zone on any macro fear day. If we get a real retail-sales-driven flush to \$245, back up the truck.

TIME HORIZON: 12-24 months. The catalyst I'm waiting for: two consecutive quarters of AWS growth accelerating above 20% — that's when the multiple re-rates higher.

WHEN TO BAIL: AWS growth below 15%, an adverse FTC breakup ruling, or if operating margins compress two quarters in a row despite ad revenue growth. Any of those and I'm reassessing.

HEDGING: Simplest hedge — buy a put option struck around \$250 expiring 3-6 months out. Think of it as insurance: you pay a small premium, and if the stock crashes, the put pays you back. Alternatively, pair the long AMZN with a short in a weaker pure-play retailer to isolate the AWS/ads exposure.

Procure Space ETF

SPCX NASDAQ

Hold	\$138.94 ▼ 1.67%	12M Price Target \$155.00	52-Week Range \$104.83 – \$225.64	Market Cap \$1.83T
------	------------------	------------------------------	--------------------------------------	-----------------------

SPCX: Space ETF Cools After Musk's \$900B Reveal

WHAT HAPPENED

- SPCX is down 1.67% today to \$138.94, and honestly the price action this week has been schizophrenic — up 9.6% Wednesday, down 3.3% Thursday, down again today. That's classic "hot money" behavior (short-term traders piling in and out), not conviction buying.
- The Musk/SpaceX \$900B stake filing is the headline mover — it's technically bullish for space as a theme, but it also reminds everyone that SPCX is heavily influenced by one privately-held megacap it can't even fully own. That's a double-edged sword.

WHY IT MATTERS

Here's what today's move really tells you: the space trade is getting "frothy" (meaning too much excitement, not enough fundamentals) and traders are taking profits after the SpaceX headlines. The Yahoo piece calling this "Wall Street's riskiest trades back on top" is a warning sign — when your ETF gets lumped in with meme stocks and crypto, you're trading on sentiment, not earnings. The SpaceX-Cursor acquisition news (\$60B for an AI coding platform) signals that private space giants are now aggressively expanding into adjacent tech, which long-term expands the total market for SPCX's holdings but short-term makes valuations harder to justify. Bottom line: this is a "buy the dip, don't chase the rip" setup right now.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

The big political tailwind for SPCX is the FY2027 defense authorization currently being debated in Congress, which includes a proposed ~15% bump for Space Force procurement and satellite communications — that directly benefits SPCX holdings like Rocket Lab, Iridium, and Viasat. Also watch the FAA's commercial launch licensing reform, which the Trump administration has been pushing to streamline (fewer regulatory hoops = more launches = more revenue for launch providers). The wildcard: any ITAR export control tightening (rules on selling space tech abroad) could hurt international revenue for some SPCX components, so keep an eye on any China-related tech export announcements.

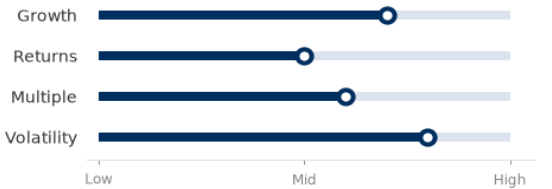
IS IT EXPENSIVE?

SPCX is trading at 28% of its 52-week range (\$105-\$226), so it's closer to the lows than the highs — not screaming expensive on price alone. But because it's an ETF, "valuation" is really the weighted average of what its holdings trade at, and space names are generally priced at 8-15x forward sales (meaning investors pay \$8-15 for every \$1 of expected revenue) versus ~3x for the broader market. That premium is defensible IF the defense/commercial space spending keeps flowing — but it's not a bargain.

Key Data

Price (USD)	\$138.94
12M Price Target	\$155.00
Upside / (Downside)	+11.6%
Market Cap	\$1.83T
FY2026E Revenue	\$0K
FY2027E Revenue	\$0K
FY2026E EPS	\$0.00
FY2027E EPS	\$0.00
Fwd P/E	N/M

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P 500



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$150.00	\$142.00	\$128.00
6 Months	\$175.00	\$155.00	\$120.00
1 Year	\$210.00	\$165.00	\$115.00
2 Years	\$260.00	\$195.00	\$105.00
5 Years	\$380.00	\$260.00	\$90.00
10 Years	\$600.00	\$400.00	\$80.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Energy (+7.2% over 5 days) is on fire, likely tied to geopolitical tension and OPEC signaling — that's rotation into "real assets." Utilities and Comm Services also holding up because of AI-power-demand thesis.

COOLING OFF: Consumer Discretionary is negative on the 5-day, which tells you the consumer is getting cautious — not great for anything speculative, including space.

ROTATION WATCH: Money is moving OUT of high-multiple growth (which includes space) and INTO cash-flowing defensives and energy. That's a mild headwind for SPCX until the rotation exhausts itself.

RELATED PLAY: If you like the space theme but want less volatility, consider defense primes like LMT or NOC — they get the same government spending tailwind but pay dividends and don't swing 10% a week.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- RKLB (Rocket Lab): Winning on launch cadence and the Neutron rocket program — direct beneficiary of commercial + defense demand.
- IRDM (Iridium): Steady cash flow from satellite communications, less speculative than pure launch names.

SPCX CONTEXT: SPCX is lagging its hottest individual holdings this week because ETFs smooth out the winners and losers. That tells you if you want maximum upside, individual names beat the ETF — but if you want diversified exposure without picking winners, SPCX does its job.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

6/10 Conviction Score

CONVICTION: 6/10 — I like the long-term space thesis but the near-term setup is choppy and sentiment-driven, not fundamentals-driven.

POSITION SIZE: 2-4% of portfolio — enough to matter if it works, small enough to survive a 30% drawdown without panic.

ENTRY POINTS: I'd add on pullbacks to \$128-133, not chase green days. The stock has shown it'll give you a re-entry.

TIME HORIZON: 12-36 months — the real catalyst is the defense budget cycle and the eventual SpaceX IPO (which would be a monster event for the sector).

WHEN TO BAIL: If the FY2027 defense bill strips space funding, or if we see a catastrophic launch failure at SpaceX/Rocket Lab, I'm reducing.

HEDGING: Easiest hedge is to keep this position small and hold some cash for when it dips. If you want to get fancy, buy a put option (a contract that pays you if the stock falls) 10% below current price as insurance during earnings season.

Robinhood Markets, Inc.

HOOD NASDAQ

Hold	\$97.06 ▼ 2.32%	12M Price Target \$105.00	52-Week Range \$63.52 – \$153.86	Market Cap \$87.26B
------	-----------------	------------------------------	-------------------------------------	------------------------

HOOD: Crypto Chill and S&P Snub Weigh on Sentiment

WHAT HAPPENED

- Reddit got added to the S&P 500 and is popping 11% pre-market — HOOD did NOT get the nod, and that's likely a big reason it's slipping today. Getting into the S&P forces every index fund on earth to buy your stock, so missing out is a real "what could have been" moment for HOOD holders.
- Coinbase is down and dragging the whole crypto-broker cohort with it. HOOD now gets ~25% of revenue from crypto, so when COIN sneezes, HOOD catches a cold.

WHY IT MATTERS

The S&P snub is the real story — traders had been front-running an inclusion trade for weeks, and today's dip is that hot money leaving. But here's the flip side: HOOD still meets most inclusion criteria (profitable, liquid, US-domiciled), so it's likely a "when not if" — meaning any deeper pullback becomes a setup for the next inclusion cycle review. The bigger picture: the Trump administration's crypto-friendly stance (CLARITY Act passed, SEC dropped its enforcement-first approach) has been rocket fuel for HOOD's crypto and tokenization business — that tailwind is still fully intact, today's move is noise, not signal. Watch the put flow though: someone's buying \$111-114 strike puts aggressively, which suggests smart money is hedging near-term downside into what could be a choppy August.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

The regulatory setup is about as good as it gets for HOOD right now — the CLARITY Act (which finally defined which crypto tokens are securities vs. commodities) removed years of legal ambiguity, and the SEC under the new administration has greenlit tokenized equities, which HOOD is actively rolling out in the EU and pushing to launch stateside. Watch for the Section 899 "revenge tax" debate and any prediction market legislation — HOOD's event contracts business (sports, elections) is a sleeper growth driver that could get either blessed or crushed depending on how the CFTC rules land this fall. Net-net: the regulatory wind is at HOOD's back in a way it simply wasn't 18 months ago.

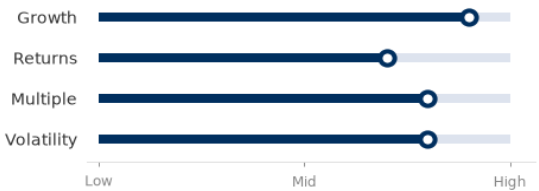
IS IT EXPENSIVE?

At \$97, you're paying roughly 52x next year's earnings — meaning \$52 for every \$1 of profit — versus the S&P at ~22x and Schwab at ~20x. That's expensive, but HOOD is growing revenue 40%+ while Schwab grows single digits, so the premium isn't crazy IF crypto stays hot and the options business keeps compounding. The stock sits at just 37% of its 52-week range (\$63-\$154), which tells you the froth has already come out — it's not cheap, but it's not the euphoric top either.

Key Data

Price (USD)	\$97.06
12M Price Target	\$105.00
Upside / (Downside)	+8.2%
Market Cap	\$87.26B
FY2026E Revenue	\$4,200M
FY2027E Revenue	\$5,100M
FY2026E EPS	\$1.85
FY2027E EPS	\$2.40
Fwd P/E	52.5x

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P; 500



HOOD — Robinhood Markets, Inc. | August 14, 2026

PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$110.00	\$98.00	\$85.00
6 Months	\$130.00	\$105.00	\$78.00
1 Year	\$160.00	\$115.00	\$70.00
2 Years	\$200.00	\$140.00	\$60.00
5 Years	\$300.00	\$180.00	\$50.00
10 Years	\$500.00	\$250.00	\$40.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Energy is on fire (+7% in 5 days) — that's the tariff/OPEC dynamic plus summer demand. Utilities catching a bid on AI-datacenter-power thesis.

COOLING OFF: Consumer Discretionary is limping (-0.9% over 5 days) — tariff pass-through hitting retail is the read, and Walmart/Target earnings this week will confirm or deny.

ROTATION WATCH: Money is rotating OUT of speculative fintech (HOOD, COIN) and INTO defensive names and energy — classic late-summer risk-off setup ahead of Jackson Hole and September Fed meeting.

RELATED PLAY: If HOOD's tokenization thesis plays out, the real winners might be the plumbing — think crypto custodians, stablecoin issuers (Circle), and the exchanges themselves (CME for regulated crypto derivatives).

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- RDDT (Reddit): Just got S&P 500 inclusion — automatic 8-11% pop from forced index fund buying. This is the trade HOOD holders wish they had.
- IBKR (Interactive Brokers): Grinding higher on the same options/retail-trading tailwinds as HOOD but at a much cheaper multiple (~25x earnings vs HOOD's 52x).

HOOD CONTEXT: HOOD is lagging its peer group today specifically because of the S&P snub, not fundamentals. That's actually a decent signal — when a stock drops on flow/technical reasons rather than business deterioration, the pullback tends to be shorter-lived. But it also means HOOD needs a new catalyst (earnings beat, S&P re-consideration, crypto rally) to reclaim leadership.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

6/10 Conviction Score

Position Size: 2-4% of portfolio

Entry Points: \$85-90 on crypto pullbacks

Time Horizon: 12-24 months

Thesis Invalidation: Sustained crypto bear market or reversal of CLARITY Act / SEC crypto rules

Hedging: Buy protective puts or pair against COIN

Meta Platforms, Inc.

META NASDAQ

Buy **\$596.40** ▲ 0.24% 12M Price Target **\$725.00** 52-Week Range **\$520.26 – \$796.25**

Market Cap
\$1.52T

META: Cheap Giant, But AI Spending Skepticism Creeping In

WHAT HAPPENED

- Stock is basically flat but the narrative is shifting — an analyst is publicly calling Meta's AI progress an "illusion," and there's a viral story about the \$250B Louisiana data center creating just 1,000 jobs (\$250M per job). Neither is a fundamental change, but together they crystallize the market's growing worry: Zuck is spending like crazy on AI and the payoff isn't obvious yet.
- The COO dumped shares last week (small dollar amount but insider selling with zero buys) and options flow is heavily skewed to puts — smart money is hedging near-term downside even though the stock isn't cracking.

WHY IT MATTERS

Here's the real story: META is sitting at 28% of its 52-week range (closer to the low than the high) even though the core ad business is still a printing press. That means the market has already priced in AI capex anxiety — which is actually a setup, not a warning. When expectations get low and the company keeps delivering 20%+ ad growth, the stock re-rates higher. But watch the political overlay: the Louisiana data center story is exactly the kind of narrative that invites populist scrutiny from both parties — Republicans on energy grid strain, Democrats on jobs-per-dollar. If that becomes a talking point in Congress, expect more headline volatility. The bearish put flow at \$690-740 strikes tells me institutions think upside is capped near-term, not that a crash is coming.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

Two things to watch: (1) The FTC's ongoing antitrust case trying to force Meta to divest Instagram and WhatsApp is still grinding through appeals — a loss here is the single biggest tail risk, but timeline is likely 2027+. (2) The Kids Online Safety Act (KOSA) and various state-level social media age verification laws are creating compliance costs, but they're actually a moat — Meta can afford compliance, TikTok and smaller players can't. Also worth noting: any executive action restricting Chinese app competition (TikTok specifically) is a direct tailwind — Reels benefits immediately if TikTok gets squeezed further.

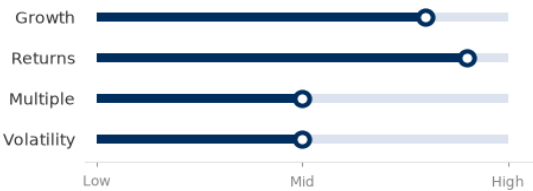
IS IT EXPENSIVE?

At \$596, META trades around 21-22x forward earnings — meaning you're paying \$22 for every \$1 the company is expected to earn next year. That's roughly in line with the S&P 500 average, but META is growing faster and has fatter margins than the average company. Compare to Google at ~19x and Microsoft at ~30x — META is priced like a mature utility while still growing like a tech company. The 24/7 Wall St. headline calling META and GOOG "incredible value" isn't wrong; the question is what breaks the discount.

Key Data

Price (USD)	\$596.40
12M Price Target	\$725.00
Upside / (Downside)	+21.6%
Market Cap	\$1.52T
FY2026E Revenue	\$205M
FY2027E Revenue	\$238M
FY2026E EPS	\$27.50
FY2027E EPS	\$32.00
Fwd P/E	21.7x

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P 500



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$640.00	\$605.00	\$555.00
6 Months	\$720.00	\$650.00	\$530.00
1 Year	\$800.00	\$725.00	\$500.00
2 Years	\$950.00	\$800.00	\$480.00
5 Years	\$1300.00	\$1000.00	\$550.00
10 Years	\$2000.00	\$1400.00	\$600.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Energy (+7.2% over 5 days) — this is a tell. Power demand from AI data centers is driving utility and energy names, and it validates Meta's infrastructure spend even as investors complain about it. Communication Services (Meta's sector) is quietly up 1.65% this week.

COOLING OFF: Consumer Discretionary is lagging (-0.91% over 5 days) — hints at consumer softness, which eventually shows up in ad budgets.

ROTATION WATCH: Money is flowing to "AI picks and shovels" (energy, utilities, data center infra) rather than the AI end-consumers (Meta, Google). That's a rotation Meta needs to reverse by showing AI is boosting ad revenue, not just costing money.

RELATED PLAY: If you believe the AI infra story, the second-order winners are power/utility names (VST, CEG) and data center REITs (EQIX, DLR). These are effectively long-Meta-capex without the ad-cycle risk.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- RDDT (Reddit): +12% today on S&P 500 inclusion — forced buying by index funds. Also a social media/ad play, which shows the sub-sector isn't broken, just Meta-specific fatigue.
- GOOGL (Alphabet): Grouped with META in the "incredible value" narrative — both trading at market multiples with above-market growth.

META CONTEXT: META is lagging its peer group meaningfully — it's at 28% of its 52-week range while the broader Comm Services sector is grinding higher. That's usually a coiled spring or a broken stock; given the earnings power, I lean coiled spring. The next earnings report is the catalyst that decides which.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

7/10 Conviction Score

CONVICTION: 7/10 — Cautiously bullish. The valuation is compelling and the core business is dominant, but the AI capex overhang is real and near-term catalysts are limited.

POSITION SIZE: 4-6% of portfolio. Big enough to matter, small enough that a capex-driven 15% drawdown doesn't ruin your year.

ENTRY POINTS: I'd add on pullbacks to \$575-585 — that's where the stock has found support recently. Don't chase above \$620 until earnings.

TIME HORIZON: 12-24 months. The catalyst I'm waiting for is either (a) AI capex plateau signal on the next earnings call, or (b) evidence AI is meaningfully lifting ad ROI/pricing.

WHEN TO BAIL: If quarterly ad revenue growth drops below 10% year-over-year, or if the FTC wins a first-round ruling forcing Instagram divestiture, I'm out.

HEDGING: Simplest hedge — pair the long with a small short in a weaker ad-dependent name like SNAP or PINS. If ads roll over, they crack first. Alternatively, own some longer-dated puts as cheap insurance against a capex shock.

Micron Technology, Inc.

MU NASDAQ

Buy

\$973.50 ▲ 2.49%

12M Price Target
\$1100.00

52-Week Range
\$113.46 – \$1255.00

Market Cap
\$1.10T

MU: Memory Supercycle Roars Back, Korea Rally Confirms

WHAT HAPPENED

- MU jumped another 2.5% to \$973, capping a 13% rip in five sessions. The catalyst is global: Korea's KOSPI just re-entered a bull market, with SK Hynix and Samsung — MU's two direct HBM competitors — ripping overnight. When the whole memory complex moves together like this, it's the market pricing in that DRAM/HBM prices are going HIGHER, not just that MU won a contract.
- The Intel-back-into-memory chatter (Investing.com piece) is noise for now, but worth flagging — if Intel actually redeploys \$20B into memory, that's a 3-year headwind. Market is ignoring it because Intel is years away from being competitive.

WHY IT MATTERS

Here's what this move is really telling you: memory is no longer a "cyclical trade" — the market is starting to price it like AI infrastructure, which means higher sustained multiples. The fact that MU is up 13% in a week on ZERO company-specific news means this is a macro/sector re-rating, driven by HBM (High Bandwidth Memory, the chips that sit next to Nvidia GPUs) pricing power. The trillion-dollar market cap is doing something psychologically important — MU has joined the AI mega-cap club, which brings passive index buying but also means every AI wobble now hits harder. Watch for a cooling-off: today's volume was only 7M vs 36M yesterday, so this last leg up is thin and could give back a few percent easily.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

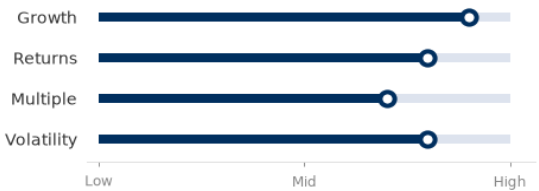
The CHIPS Act remains MU's biggest tailwind — they've already been awarded ~\$6.1B in direct grants for their Idaho and NY fabs, and the Trump administration's push to onshore semiconductor manufacturing has been surprisingly consistent (tariff rhetoric aside, the money is flowing). The active watch item: export controls on advanced memory to China. If the administration tightens HBM export rules further — which has been discussed all summer — it's a double-edged sword: hurts revenue short-term (China is ~11% of sales) but locks Samsung/SK Hynix out of the same market, protecting MU's US/allied customer base. Also keep an eye on any noise around Section 232 tariffs on semiconductors, which would be a net positive for domestic fab operators like MU.

IS IT EXPENSIVE?

Key Data

Price (USD)	\$973.50
12M Price Target	\$1100.00
Upside / (Downside)	+13.0%
Market Cap	\$1.10T
FY2026E Revenue	\$48,500M
FY2027E Revenue	\$62,000M
FY2026E EPS	\$14.20
FY2027E EPS	\$22.50
Fwd P/E	68.5x

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P 500



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$1080.00	\$1000.00	\$880.00
6 Months	\$1300.00	\$1150.00	\$850.00
1 Year	\$1500.00	\$1200.00	\$780.00
2 Years	\$1800.00	\$1350.00	\$700.00
5 Years	\$2500.00	\$1700.00	\$600.00
10 Years	\$4000.00	\$2400.00	\$500.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Energy (+7% in 5 days) is quietly leading — that's an AI power-demand story as much as an oil story. Memory/semis obviously ripping on the Korea bull market read-through.

COOLING OFF: Consumer Discretionary is soft (-0.9% on 5D), suggesting consumer is weakening — usually a late-cycle tell that could eventually catch up to semis.

ROTATION WATCH: Money is flowing INTO AI infrastructure (memory, power, data center) and OUT of consumer-facing tech. This is a direct tailwind for MU as long as it lasts.

RELATED PLAY: If MU keeps running, the picks-and-shovels beneath it — ASML (litho equipment), Applied Materials (AMAT), and utilities powering the data centers (VST, CEG) — all benefit from the same capex wave.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- **SNDK (SanDisk):** Up 7% today, riding NAND flash pricing recovery — same supply-discipline story as DRAM.
- **WDC (Western Digital):** Up 4%, similar storage/memory tailwind. The whole storage complex is being re-rated.

MU CONTEXT: MU is actually LAGGING the smaller memory names today (+3% vs +7% for SNDK), which is normal at this stage — money hits the mega-cap first, then chases the smaller, more levered plays. If you're already long MU, that's fine. If you want fresh exposure, the smaller names have more torque but also more downside if the trade unwinds.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

8/10 Conviction Score

Position Size: 3-5% of portfolio

Entry Points: \$880-920 on pullbacks

Time Horizon: 12-24 months

Thesis Invalidation: HBM pricing rolls over, or Intel/Samsung meaningfully closes the technology gap

Hedging: Pair with a short on a smaller memory name or buy SOXS puts as tail protection

Tesla, Inc.
TSLA NASDAQ

Hold \$348.83 ▲ 2.61% 12M Price Target \$375.00 52-Week Range \$297.38 – \$498.83

Market Cap \$1.38T

TSLA: Texas Solar Bet Fuels Rally, But Options Flash Caution

WHAT HAPPENED

- TSLA is up 2.6% to \$348.83 on a 2-week win streak — the big news is Tesla plowing \$10.1B into Texas solar plus hinting at satellite internet baked into cars. Translation: they're doubling down on the "we're not just a car company" narrative, and the market is buying it (literally).
- But watch the options tape — heavy unusual PUT buying at \$430-\$450 strikes for August expiry (contracts betting the stock FALLS). Someone with size is either hedging or betting this rally runs out of gas before hitting the 52-week high of \$498.

WHY IT MATTERS

The Texas solar spend is smart positioning — with the Trump administration killing the \$7,500 EV tax credit last year, Tesla's auto growth story is under pressure, so pivoting capital toward energy storage (which IS still getting federal support via grid modernization funding) diversifies the political risk. But here's the tension: the stock is trading at ~\$1.38T market cap on a business that fundamentally still sells cars, and Q2 delivery growth has been anemic. The rally is a NARRATIVE rally — solar, robotaxi, Optimus, satellite — not an earnings rally. That means it's fragile: any single disappointment (robotaxi delay, solar project cost overrun) could unwind fast, which is exactly what the put buyers are positioning for.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

Two big policy crosscurrents right now: (1) The EV tax credit is GONE as of late 2025, which is a real headwind for Tesla's US auto demand — you're seeing it in the sideways delivery numbers. (2) On the flip side, the administration's push for domestic energy dominance and grid resiliency is a tailwind for Tesla Energy (Megapack, solar) — the Texas \$10B bet is essentially Tesla front-running expected state and federal incentives for battery storage. Also watch China tariffs: Tesla's Shanghai gigafactory is a huge profit center, and any escalation in the trade fight (rumors of new tariffs on Chinese-made vehicles re-exported to Europe) could hit margins directly.

IS IT EXPENSIVE?

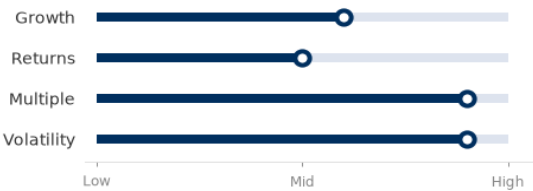
At ~\$349, TSLA trades around 122x forward earnings — meaning investors are paying \$122 for every \$1 the company is expected to earn next year. For comparison, Toyota trades at ~10x and even Nvidia is around 35x. That's not a car valuation, that's a "we believe robotaxis and Optimus will change the world" valuation — and it's only justified if those bets actually deliver in the next 2-3 years.

WHAT COULD GO WRONG

Key Data

Price (USD)	\$348.83
12M Price Target	\$375.00
Upside / (Downside)	+7.5%
Market Cap	\$1.38T
FY2026E Revenue	\$118M
FY2027E Revenue	\$142M
FY2026E EPS	\$2.85
FY2027E EPS	\$3.90
Fwd P/E	122.4x

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P 500



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$380.00	\$355.00	\$315.00
6 Months	\$450.00	\$375.00	\$280.00
1 Year	\$500.00	\$375.00	\$250.00
2 Years	\$600.00	\$400.00	\$220.00
5 Years	\$900.00	\$500.00	\$180.00
10 Years	\$1500.00	\$700.00	\$150.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Energy (+7.2% over 5 days) — this is the dominant story this week, driven by supply concerns and the administration's energy dominance agenda. That indirectly helps Tesla Energy.

COOLING OFF: Consumer Discretionary (-0.9% over 5 days) — this is Tesla's official sector, and it's lagging, which tells you the auto side of TSLA isn't what's driving this rally.

ROTATION WATCH: Money is rotating OUT of pure consumer names and INTO energy/infrastructure — Tesla is uniquely positioned to catch both waves because it's classified as consumer disc but increasingly acts like an energy/AI hybrid.

RELATED PLAY: If you believe the Tesla Energy story, look at grid-scale battery and utility-adjacent names — companies like GE Vernova (GEV) or even Fluence (FLNC) benefit from the same grid modernization tailwind without the Musk-narrative premium.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- NVDA (Nvidia): Still the AI infrastructure king — every Tesla robotaxi/Optimus story indirectly validates the AI compute demand thesis.
- GEV (GE Vernova): Grid and power equipment play riding the same energy dominance policy wave that's boosting Tesla Energy.

TSLA CONTEXT: TSLA is leading consumer discretionary this week but lagging the pure AI/energy names on a 6-month basis. That tells me the market is treating it as a "hybrid bet" — you're getting some AI premium but the auto anchor is holding it back from truly running with the Nvidias of the world.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

5/10 Conviction Score

CONVICTION: 5/10 — I'm cautiously neutral. The narrative is real but the valuation leaves no room for error, and the put flow is telling me smart money is hedging.

POSITION SIZE: 2-4% max. This isn't a "back up the truck" name at these levels — it's a volatility monster with binary outcomes on robotaxi.

ENTRY POINTS: I'd wait for pullbacks to \$310-325 (near the 52-week low zone). Chasing at \$349 after a 2-week run is bad risk/reward.

TIME HORIZON: 12-24 months — the catalyst you're waiting for is either (a) robotaxi actually scaling in 2-3 cities with real revenue, or (b) Tesla Energy hitting a \$30B+ annualized run rate.

WHEN TO BAIL: Bail if auto gross margin drops below 12%, if the Austin robotaxi gets suspended by regulators, or if Musk announces he's stepping further back from Tesla for xAI.

HEDGING: Easiest hedge — buy some longer-dated protective puts (contracts that pay off if the stock falls) around the \$300 strike. Costs a bit but sleeps well when Musk tweets at 2am.

NVIDIA Corporation

NVDA NASDAQ

Buy	\$225.67 ▲ 0.16%	12M Price Target \$260.00	52-Week Range \$164.07 – \$236.54	Market Cap \$5.47T
-----	------------------	------------------------------	--------------------------------------	-----------------------

NVDA: Grinding Higher Despite AI Bubble Chatter

WHAT HAPPENED

- NVDA barely moved (+0.16%) but is sitting near the top of its 52-week range (85th percentile) — that's actually notable given the market got spooked by a surprise retail sales print. Translation: when the Dow is falling and NVDA holds firm, that's the market saying "this is still the safe AI trade."
- Applied Materials (semiconductor equipment) tanked on earnings, but NVDA shrugged it off — that tells me investors are separating "chip demand" (still strong) from "chip factory buildout" (slowing). NVDA benefits from the former.

WHY IT MATTERS

Two Yahoo headlines today are essentially arguing "the AI trade is getting long in the tooth" — one saying \$1T in cash can't fix the buildout bottleneck (power/grid), the other saying the next winners won't look like NVDA. When you see this much skepticism at all-time highs, it's usually contrarian bullish — the bubble talk shows up before the top, not at it. The real read-through: the market is starting to price in a rotation away from pure GPU names toward power, cooling, and grid infrastructure, which is why Energy is up 7% in 5 days. For NVDA specifically, this means the stock can keep grinding higher on earnings power, but the explosive multiple expansion phase is probably behind us — from here, it's an earnings-driven stock, not a story stock.

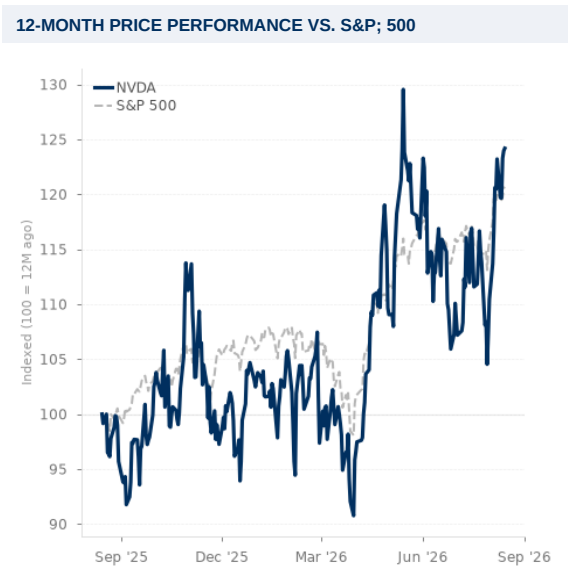
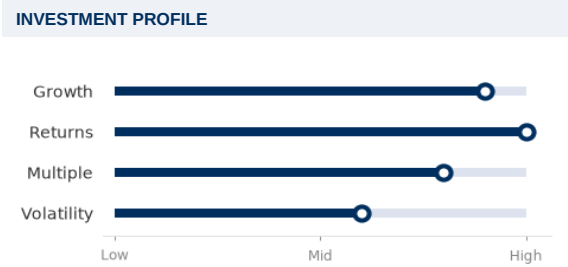
POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

The big one to watch: the Trump administration's H2O chip deal with China, where NVDA agreed to give the US government 15% of China revenue in exchange for export licenses — that's a novel "revenue-sharing tariff" structure that could set precedent across tech. If that framework holds, NVDA gets back billions in China revenue Wall Street had already zeroed out; if Congress pushes back (some hawks are calling it unconstitutional), that upside evaporates. Also watch the CHIPS Act 2.0 discussions and any executive orders on federal AI procurement — Uncle Sam is now effectively an NVDA customer AND a revenue-share partner, which is a weird but powerful alignment.

IS IT EXPENSIVE?

At roughly 51x forward earnings, you're paying \$51 for every \$1 of profit NVDA will earn next year — that sounds expensive, but they're growing earnings 40%+ so the PEG ratio (price relative to growth) is actually reasonable at ~1.2. Compare to Palantir at 200x+ or even AMD at 40x with slower growth, and NVDA is arguably the cheapest premium AI name. The valuation is justified as long as data center revenue keeps compounding — the day that number decelerates below 25% YoY, the multiple gets crushed.

Key Data	
Price (USD)	\$225.67
12M Price Target	\$260.00
Upside / (Downside)	+15.2%
Market Cap	\$5.47T
FY2026E Revenue	\$205M
FY2027E Revenue	\$268M
FY2026E EPS	\$4.45
FY2027E EPS	\$5.90
Fwd P/E	50.7x



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$240.00	\$230.00	\$210.00
6 Months	\$270.00	\$245.00	\$195.00
1 Year	\$310.00	\$260.00	\$180.00
2 Years	\$400.00	\$320.00	\$200.00
5 Years	\$600.00	\$450.00	\$220.00
10 Years	\$900.00	\$650.00	\$250.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Energy (+7% in 5 days) and Utilities — the market has figured out that AI needs power, and power needs generation and grid. This is a direct second-derivative AI trade.

COOLING OFF: Consumer Discretionary (-0.9% in 5 days) — surprise retail sales data today suggests the consumer is finally cracking, which raises recession odds.

ROTATION WATCH: Money is rotating from "AI chips" to "AI infrastructure" — power, cooling, data center REITs. NVDA isn't losing money to this rotation yet because it's still the highest-conviction earnings story, but the marginal AI dollar is going elsewhere.

RELATED PLAY: If you believe the AI story but think NVDA is tapped out, look at Vistra (VST), Constellation Energy (CEG), or Eaton (ETN) — they sell the power and electrical gear that AI data centers can't run without.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- SK Hynix / Samsung (KOSPI +2.4% overnight): Korean memory names are ripping because HBM (high-bandwidth memory that goes into NVDA GPUs) demand is off the charts — this is a direct positive read-through for NVDA
- Energy sector broadly: benefiting from the "AI needs power" narrative catching mainstream attention

NVDA CONTEXT: NVDA is holding near highs while the Dow falls and Applied Materials craters — that's leadership behavior. When a stock refuses to sell off on bad tape, it usually means institutions are accumulating. The relative strength here is a bullish tell into the August 27 earnings print.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

8/10 Conviction Score

CONVICTION: 8/10 — high conviction because earnings power is real and the China optionality is now a call option Wall Street isn't fully pricing, but I'm not at 10 because the crowd is already here.

POSITION SIZE: 5-7% of portfolio — this can be a core holding, but don't YOLO it. The stock is up huge and volatility around earnings is real.

ENTRY POINTS: I'd add on any pullback to \$215-220 (roughly the 50-day moving average). If we get a broader market flush to \$200, back up the truck.

TIME HORIZON: 12-24 months. Near-term catalyst is August 27 earnings; medium-term catalyst is Blackwell Ultra ramp and China H2O revenue recognition in Q4.

WHEN TO BAIL: If data center revenue growth drops below 20% YoY, if a major hyperscaler cuts capex guidance, or if Congress kills the China H2O deal outright.

HEDGING: Simplest hedge is to buy some SOXS (inverse semiconductor ETF) or long-dated puts on SMH (the semiconductor ETF) — that protects you from a sector-wide semi selloff without betting against NVDA specifically. Cheaper hedge: just trim 20% of your position if it hits \$240 before earnings.

Alphabet Inc.

GOOGL NASDAQ

Buy	\$348.04 ▲ 0.49%	12M Price Target \$385.00	52-Week Range \$196.60 – \$408.61	Market Cap \$4.26T
-----	------------------	------------------------------	--------------------------------------	-----------------------

GOOGL: Cooling Off After Rally, But AI Moat Intact

WHAT HAPPENED

- GOOGL is basically flat this morning (\$348, +0.5%) after a rough Monday-Tuesday where it dropped ~4% from \$357 to \$343. The market's digesting two things: Google raised cloud prices citing a memory chip shortage (that's a margin positive but a demand-signal negative), and Gemini launched an AI doctor-booking integration with Zocdoc — expanding the healthcare AI footprint.
- The volume today is unusually thin (~2.4M vs 18-29M all week), which just means it's a sleepy Friday in August, not a real signal.

WHY IT MATTERS

Nothing major happened overnight — the thesis is intact. Keep an eye on price action and how the sector is moving for a potential entry point.

IS IT EXPENSIVE?

See key data table.

WHAT COULD GO WRONG

- DOJ antitrust remedy comes in harsher than expected — if they force any structural separation (Chrome, ad-tech), the sum-of-the-parts math gets ugly fast.
- Cloud growth deceleration — if AWS or Azure start eating GOOGL's share in enterprise AI workloads, the multiple compresses hard because Cloud is the growth story.
- The non-obvious one: Gemini becoming "too good" at answering queries directly could cannibalize the core Search ad business faster than YouTube and Cloud can offset it. That's the internal tension nobody's pricing in.

IN THE NEWS

Gemini & Zocdoc launch AI doctor booking Yahoo Finance Video · 2026-08-13 19:59

Google becomes latest company to raise prices thanks to memory shortage Yahoo Finance · 2026-08-13 15:10

I Keep Buying Alphabet Because Leadership Understands One Thing Far Better Than Other Hype... 24/7 Wall St. · 2026-08-14 13:33

5 Revealing Analyst Questions From Taboola's Q2 Earnings Call StockStory · 2026-08-14 13:33

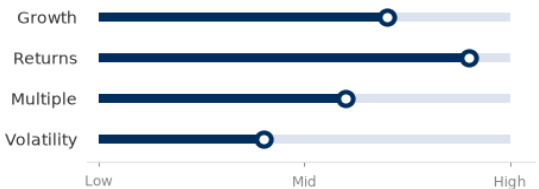
Reddit Gains 12% by Joining the S&P 500 GuruFocus.com · 2026-08-14 13:02

WHAT OPTIONS TRADERS ARE DOING

Key Data

Price (USD)	\$348.04
12M Price Target	\$385.00
Upside / (Downside)	+10.6%
Market Cap	\$4.26T
FY2026E Revenue	\$415M
FY2027E Revenue	\$470M
FY2026E EPS	\$9.85
FY2027E EPS	\$11.40
Fwd P/E	35.3x

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P 500



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$370.00	\$352.00	\$325.00
6 Months	\$410.00	\$375.00	\$310.00
1 Year	\$450.00	\$385.00	\$290.00
2 Years	\$525.00	\$430.00	\$275.00
5 Years	\$750.00	\$550.00	\$300.00
10 Years	\$1200.00	\$800.00	\$350.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Energy (+7.2% in 5 days) is ripping — likely a mix of geopolitical premium and AI-datacenter power demand. Utilities also firm, which is the "AI needs electricity" trade playing out.

COOLING OFF: Consumer Discretionary is the only red sector on 5-day (-0.9%) — suggests the consumer is getting tired, which is a background worry for GOOGL's ad revenue.

ROTATION WATCH: Money is quietly rotating from high-flying tech into energy/utilities as the "picks and shovels" AI infrastructure trade broadens out. That's why GOOGL is chopping — capital is diversifying within the AI theme, not exiting it.

RELATED PLAY: If you believe the AI power-demand thesis, the second-order winners are nuclear (VST, CEG) and grid infrastructure (GEV) — those benefit whether GOOGL, MSFT, or META wins the AI race.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- META (Meta Platforms): Ad-tech beast with less antitrust overhang and cleaner AI narrative — Reels + Llama monetization is working.
- MSFT (Microsoft): Copilot revenue is showing up in the numbers now; enterprise AI adoption is running ahead of GOOGL's Workspace AI.

GOOGL CONTEXT: GOOGL has actually been leading MSFT and META year-to-date off the lows, but it's giving back some relative strength this month. That's not a rejection — it's rotation within the mega-cap AI leaders, and GOOGL's Waymo optionality is a differentiator none of the others have.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

8/10 Conviction Score

CONVICTION: 8/10 — Strong hand, not pounding the table. The business is executing, the antitrust cloud is lifting, but the stock has already run a lot.

POSITION SIZE: 5-8% of portfolio — this is a core holding, not a trade. Big enough to matter, small enough to add on dips.

ENTRY POINTS: I'd nibble at \$340 and back up the truck at \$325 if we get a broader market pullback. Chasing \$360+ here doesn't offer great risk/reward.

TIME HORIZON: 12-24 months. The catalysts I'm waiting for are the DOJ remedy finalization and two more quarters of Cloud growth confirmation.

WHEN TO BAIL: If Cloud growth prints below 20% for two consecutive quarters, or if the DOJ forces a Chrome/Android divestiture, I'm cutting the position in half.

HEDGING: Simplest hedge — if you own \$10K of GOOGL, spend \$200-300 on a Sept or Oct put option roughly 5% below current price. Think of it as insurance on your car — you hope you never use it, but sleep better knowing it's there.

Marvell Technology, Inc.

MRVL NASDAQ

Buy	\$221.62 ▼ 0.25%	12M Price Target \$260.00	52-Week Range \$61.44 – \$329.88	Market Cap \$198.91B
-----	------------------	------------------------------	-------------------------------------	-------------------------

MRVL: NVIDIA's \$2B Vote of Confidence Changes the Story

WHAT HAPPENED

- NVIDIA reportedly took a \$2B stake in MRVL — that's the headline mover. This isn't just capital; it's Jensen basically saying "we need Marvell in our ecosystem." MRVL designs custom AI chips (ASICs) and the high-speed networking gear that ties AI data centers together — NVIDIA validating that publicly is a huge credibility stamp.
- Stock is up ~6% over the last 4 sessions on heavy volume, then paused today on tiny volume (2.9M vs usual 20M+) — that's just a breather after the run, not a reversal. Simply Wall St flagging the "290% run" premium tells you sentiment is stretched but not broken.

WHY IT MATTERS

The NVIDIA investment reframes MRVL from "one of many AI chip vendors" to "strategic NVIDIA partner" — that's a re-rating catalyst, meaning Wall Street will start assigning it a higher earnings multiple because the risk profile just dropped. Here's the inference: NVIDIA doesn't write \$2B checks casually, so this likely locks in networking silicon design wins for NVIDIA's next-gen Rubin/Feynman AI systems, which extends MRVL's revenue visibility into 2028. The put/call ratio at 0.98 and that unusual \$275 September put buy tells me some big players are hedging the run-up — smart, not scary. What to watch: if MRVL holds above \$215 into next earnings, this becomes a \$250+ stock; if it can't, the NVIDIA news gets priced in and we consolidate.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

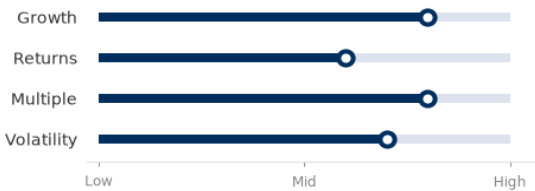
The CHIPS Act is MRVL's quiet best friend — they're a US-headquartered fabless chip designer (they design, TSMC manufactures), and the Trump administration's push to onshore advanced packaging and design work directly benefits them via tax credits and preferred federal contracting. Watch two things right now: (1) the ongoing US-China semiconductor export control tightening — MRVL has China exposure (~15% of revenue), so any new restrictions on AI chip exports could pinch that segment, and (2) the proposed AI infrastructure federal spending package being floated in the Senate that would fund national AI compute clusters — MRVL's custom silicon and optical DSPs (chips that move data at light speed between servers) are exactly what those clusters need. Net-net: policy environment is a tailwind, with China as the one wild card.

IS IT EXPENSIVE?

Key Data

Price (USD)	\$221.62
12M Price Target	\$260.00
Upside / (Downside)	+17.3%
Market Cap	\$198.91B
FY2027E Revenue	\$8,900M
FY2028E Revenue	\$11,400M
FY2027E EPS	\$2.85
FY2028E EPS	\$4.10
Fwd P/E	77.8x

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P 500



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$240.00	\$225.00	\$200.00
6 Months	\$275.00	\$245.00	\$190.00
1 Year	\$310.00	\$260.00	\$180.00
2 Years	\$380.00	\$300.00	\$160.00
5 Years	\$550.00	\$400.00	\$180.00
10 Years	\$900.00	\$600.00	\$200.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Energy (+7.2% this week) — that's the AI power story; data centers need massive electricity, and both parties are pushing nuclear/natural gas to feed them. Utilities are quietly climbing for the same reason. Comm Services is riding the AI content and cloud narrative.

COOLING OFF: Consumer Discretionary is soft (-0.9% weekly) — signals consumer stress, which usually doesn't hurt MRVL directly but can cause broad market wobbles.

ROTATION WATCH: Money is flowing into anything that powers AI (energy, utilities, semis) and out of consumer names. That's a direct tailwind — MRVL sits at the intersection of semis and AI infrastructure.

RELATED PLAY: If you like MRVL's setup, the AI power buildout beneficiaries — nuclear names like VST/CEG and grid infrastructure plays — are the second-order trade. They're picks-and-shovels for the picks-and-shovels.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- AVGO (Broadcom): Direct MRVL peer in custom AI silicon — winning huge Google TPU business, sets the pricing power benchmark for the space.
- NVDA (NVIDIA): The center of gravity for AI compute — its capex commentary drives the whole sector, and now it's literally invested in MRVL.

MRVL CONTEXT: MRVL has lagged AVGO and NVDA on a 2-year basis but the NVIDIA stake closes the credibility gap. It's now in the "tier 1 AI silicon" conversation, not the "also-ran" bucket. That re-rating is what powers the next leg higher — MRVL going from lagger to leader within the peer group is the setup.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

7/10 Conviction Score

Position Size: 3-5% of portfolio

Entry Points: \$205-215 on pullbacks

Time Horizon: 12-24 months

Thesis Invalidation: Loss of Amazon Trainium or Google TPU custom silicon contracts, or AI capex slowdown

Hedging: Buy protective puts or pair with short position in a richer AI multiple name

The following stocks were identified by screening a curated universe against the current watchlist's investment themes, today's macro environment, and smart-money signals. Scores reflect theme alignment, momentum, valuation, and institutional flow. These are research leads — not investment advice.

1	SMCI	Super Micro Computer, Inc. Semiconductors	8.9/10	BUY
Price: \$40.10 · 1M: +45.0% · P/S: 0.7x · Cap: \$25.9B				
■ Add to watchlist via tickers.txt				
OPT:BULL INS:NEUT INST:BULL				
2	LDOS	Leidos Holdings, Inc. Defense Technology	8.9/10	BUY
Price: \$141.34 · 1M: +32.6% · P/S: 1.0x · Cap: \$17.8B				
■ Add to watchlist via tickers.txt				
OPT:BULL INS:NEUT INST:BULL				
3	KTOS	Kratos Defense & Security Solutions Defense Technology	8.6/10	BUY
Price: \$63.12 · 1M: +25.6% · P/S: 7.8x · Cap: \$11.9B				
■ Monitor for pullback to \$90 entry				
OPT:BULL INS:NEUT INST:BULL				
4	MDB	MongoDB, Inc. AI & Machine Learning	8.5/10	BUY
Price: \$468.48 · 1M: +35.7% · P/S: 14.5x · Cap: \$37.7B				
■ Add to watchlist via tickers.txt				
OPT:BULL INS:NEUT INST:BULL				
5	PATH	UiPath, Inc. AI & Machine Learning	8.6/10	WATCH
Price: \$16.12 · 1M: +35.0% · P/S: 5.0x · Cap: \$8.4B				
■ Monitor for pullback to \$14 entry				
OPT:BULL INS:NEUT INST:BULL				